Scientists May Have Found a Lost Roman City

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Along the Danube River in Austria, scientists may have found a whole Roman city that was lost for nearly 2,000 years.

Special scans found the city near the **hamlet** of Stein. It covered about 62 to 74 acres and had streets in a neat **grid**, like a modern city. Its biggest feature was an **open-air** theater that could hold about 8,000 people. The city was probably built next to an army camp around 80 C.E. People left about 100 years later. Nothing was destroyed, so they probably left in an orderly way.

Could this be Claudivium? That is a city named by Claudius Ptolemy, a writer from the second century. The new site matches the place he described. But no stone with the name Claudivium has been found, so scientists are not sure yet.

Archaeologist Mario Wallner and his team scanned the ground for three years. They found buried roads and about 640 coins.

Word Treasure

hamlet -- A hamlet is a very small village.

grid -- A grid is a pattern of straight lines crossing each other, like the streets of some cities.

open-air -- Open-air means outside, with no roof over it.

Archaeologist -- An archaeologist is a scientist who studies old places and objects to learn about the past.

C.E. -- C.E. is written after a year to show it is counted in the same year system most countries use today.

Background you need

Roman cities had streets, theaters and army camps, and some of them were later lost as time passed.

Archaeologists study buried remains to learn where old cities were and how people lived there.

Special scans can show buried roads and buildings under the ground, helping scientists find a lost city.

Break it down

WHO: Archaeologist Mario Wallner and his team of scientists.

WHAT: Using special scans, they may have found a whole Roman city that was lost for nearly 2,000 years.

WHERE: Along the Danube River in Austria, near the hamlet of Stein.

WHY: The site matches the place Claudius Ptolemy described for Claudivium, but no stone with that name has been found, so scientists are not sure yet.

Why it matters

It shows children that real history can still be hidden underground, waiting to be discovered.

Test what you remember

1. Along which river was the city found?

- (A) In Austria only
- (B) The Danube River
- (C) Near Stein only
- (D) A modern river

2. Near which hamlet did scans find the city?

- (A) Ptolemy
- (B) Wallner
- (C) Stein
- (D) Claudivium

3. What was the city's biggest feature?

- (A) Streets in a neat grid
- (B) About 640 coins
- (C) An open-air theater that could hold about 8,000 people
- (D) Buried roads

4. How were the city's streets laid out?

- (A) Inside an army camp
- (B) In a circle
- (C) Under a river
- (D) In a neat grid, like a modern city

5. Why are scientists not yet sure the city is Claudivium?

- (A) Because people left about 100 years later
- (B) Because nothing was destroyed
- (C) Because no stone with the name Claudivium has been found
- (D) Because the scans took three years

6. What did Mario Wallner's team find buried at the site?

- (A) Only a theater
- (B) About 640 coins and buried roads
- (C) A stone with the city's name
- (D) A modern city

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: C 4: D 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. The scientists: They are not sure yet that the city is Claudivium, because no stone with that name has been found.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):